ISSUES TO BE ADDRESSED

- Globalization
- Global Governance
- Global Emergencies
- Censorship
- New Multilateralism
- The United Nations
- Self-Determination of Peoples
- National Sovereignty
- Rule of Law
- Abstraction Language
- De-colonisation

WHO WE ARE

We are an international and interdisciplinary group of scholars, scientists, and practitioners united by a common mission to ensure that international governance and policy does not threaten the subsidiary action of the human person in ways that are antithetical to peace, security, the family, and authentic community.

MEETINGS, CONFERENCES, AND ACADEMIC PARTNERS

Strong connections exist with universities in South Africa and Australia; future connections in South Korea and other countries are anticipated. European and US universities have indicated a strong interest in future collaboration. Further academic institutions will be approached to establish liaisons connecting Europe, the Americas, Asia, and Africa.

ALL INTERESTED PARTIES AND SCHOLARS ARE INVITED TO CONTACT

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OUR PURPOSE

SUBSIDIUM exists to further the understanding of how human societies flourish best. Education is lacking about why local ordering is superior to top-down organization. SUBSIDIUM seeks to fill that gap with a particular vision and methodology.

SUBSIDIUM

SUBSIDIARITY:

'A principle of social organization that holds that social and political issues should be dealt with at the most appropriate level, usually the most immediate or local level, consistent with their resolution'

OUR VISION

Human freedom requires respect for, and measures to support, varieties of life-worlds, with toleration and accommodation of difference. Some differences might be irreconcilable under the rule of law. However, the idea that we all must be the same, think the same, celebrate the same, is the enemy of personal and associational diversity, which encourages the human person to celebrate genuine communion – what we hold in common, but need not and often will not share with others.

Beliefs of associations and community groups are a living sign of the freedom to be different. Facilitating localised, bottom-up association, rather than top-down organization, encourages the exercise of freedoms and corresponding responsibilities. While all persons share a common political good in a universal community, the notion of subsidiarity attunes communal solidarity to the respect due to free decision-making by persons and associations. It is chiefly by maintaining the rule of law and administering justice that political institutions give assistance or aid – *subsidium* – to help smaller, closer, or specialised associations to flourish by achieving their diverse ends, by their own agency. Protecting the local provides a check against rampant controls that can issue from distant, centralized or global institutions – where the purposes or agency of human associations are arrogated to bureaucratic authority, often in the name of technocratic efficiency to the detriment of authentic human goods.

SUBSIDIUM is motivated to protect against the arrogation of human freedom, especially as it is manifested by 'global governance'. Global governance can take the form of public-private partnerships – sometimes referred to as 'new multilateralism' – cultivated with the assistance of the World Economic Forum in collaboration with the United Nations, governments, non-governmental organizations, and the Big Trio of big pharma, business and media.

VISION CONTINUED...

Without strong advocacy for respectful associational difference, global governance actors become enemies of freedom. Unchecked by an emphasis on and priority for local diversity, global governance becomes a form of global colonization, in which the diversity of the local, regional, or state, is subsumed into larger top-down mandates emanating from unelected and unaccountable bodies and elites. It is increasingly imposed upon nation states, despite its inconsistency with well-established principles of international law such as democracy, de-colonization, and the self-determination of peoples.

We witnessed the lineaments of this global regime during the Covid-19 period, 2020-2022, when in a wide variety of countries, our most basic liberties were suspended without adequate empirical evidence and without sufficient judicial protection for fundamental rights and freedoms. This was often driven by a culture of legal positivism. Medical ethics was turned on its head when voluntary and informed consent, and physician-patient confidentiality, were dissolved without adequate evidentiary support. The control regime of the so-called global 'pandemic' must not be repeated. It must be articulately resisted and measures must be adopted to ensure this bureaucratic overreach is not repeated in future.

Understood in this way, the political and catastrophizing discourse of the World Economic Forum and its partners, advanced through emotion-based fearmongering unsupported by empirical evidence, on the survival of the planet and the human race, can be viewed as a logical consequence of technology, cut off from the deepest notions of meaning and purpose, and turned from the support of human life and association, to control.

VISION CONTINUED...

In contrast to this technocratic culture of control, the best human traditions are rooted in affirming the free initiative of the human person based on transcendental goods, and most notable among them are religious traditions that affirm the freedom of human conscience and worship. These traditions thrive best with freedom and support: arguing for this support will be the essence of SUBSIDIUM's work into the future.

WHAT WE WILL DO

SUBSIDIUM draws upon the richness of learning across cultures in all relevant disciplines where techniques or methods should not be separated from their purposes between and within disciplines. It seeks to reconnect techniques with purposes, pointing out the deficiencies of merely technical learning. Law, for instance, should always have its methods connected with justice and the common good; business with the good effects of honest products and just employment; and medicine with the therapy of the human person understood as more than the merely physical.

Politics involves a searching examination of the nature of the human person and the ordering of human society in relation to the cardinal virtues. These virtues - moderation, justice, wisdom and courage - supplemented with the three higher virtues of faith, hope and love, together constitute the framework of all worthwhile endeavours, rather than the amorphous and subjective language of "values" which neither clarifies nor coalesces support for genuine human goods.

SUBSIDIUM will draw on its vision of human virtue as a convening platform to enrich academic debate on international governance and policy with a focus on subsidiarity for the human person and association diversity, and to resist the technocratic culture of global governance.